The sweetness of the parsnip is balanced by mild curry powder and sharp green apple in this easy-to-prepare and warming, smooth winter soup.

parsnip and apple soup

SERVES 4 **PREP** 20 MINS **COOK** 30 MINS **FREEZE** UP TO 3 MONTHS
WITHOUT CREAM AND LEMON JUICE

1 tbsp olive oil
½ tbsp butter
½ Spanish onion, finely chopped
1 garlic clove, crushed
2 tsp mild curry powder
2¼lb (1kg) parsnips, chopped
sea salt and freshly ground black pepper
1 large Granny Smith apple, peeled, cored, and chopped
1 quart (1 liter) hot vegetable stock or light chicken stock
6 tbsp half-and-half
2 tbsp lemon juice

1 Heat the oil and butter in a large sauté pan over low heat. Add the onion, garlic, and curry powder and cook gently, stirring frequently, for 2–3 minutes or until the onion has softened. Add the parsnips and season lightly with salt and freshly ground black pepper. Turn the heat up a little and cook, stirring frequently, for 5 minutes or until the parsnips are golden.

2 Add the apple, stir for 1 minute, then pour in the stock and bring to a boil. Lower the heat and simmer for 10–12 minutes or until the parsnips are tender. Take off the heat and let cool for several minutes, then transfer to a blender or food processor and process until smooth and creamy.

3 Pass the soup through a sieve placed over the pan, then rinse out the blender or food processor with ½ cup hot water and stir this into the soup. Reheat gently, then stir in the half-and half and lemon juice. Adjust the seasoning and serve piping hot.